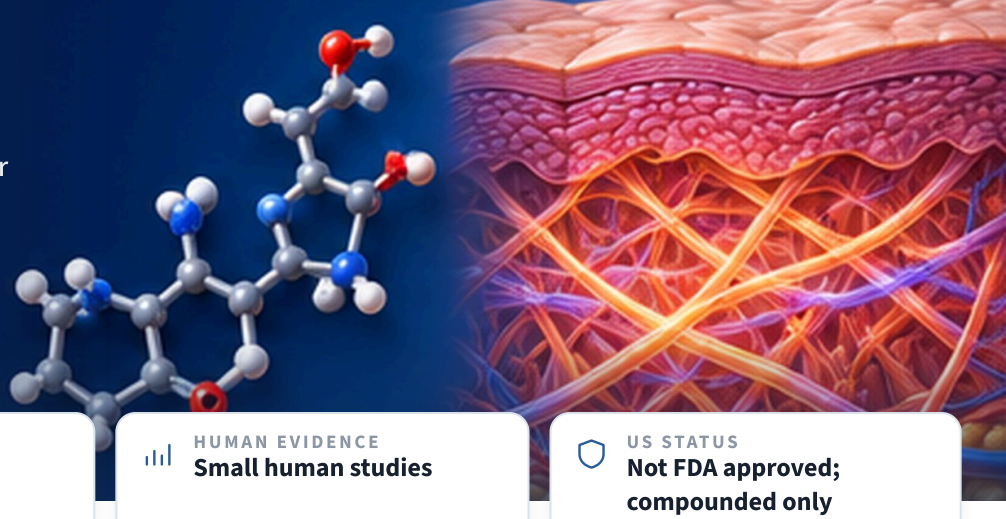
SKIN 07

Estriol

A natural estrogen (female sex hormone), weaker at the estrogen receptor than estradiol



CLASS Hormone (estrogen)

STUDIED FOR Skin aging in women

HUMAN EVIDENCE Small human studies

US STATUS Not FDA approved; compounded only

STUDIED FOR

Facial skin aging
HUMAN + ANIMAL

Vaginal atrophy
HUMAN

No studies in men. Both skin studies were in women around menopause and compared estriol with estradiol cream. No placebo-controlled trial was found.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Estriol → Estrogen receptor → Skin collagen → Skin aging signs

- **Estrogen receptor:** estriol is substantially less potent than estradiol
- **In women,** biopsies showed more type III collagen after 6 months
- **In rats,** skin effects differed between males and females
- **In men,** the effect on skin is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

SMALL HUMAN
LEVEL 3 OF 5

- 2 small studies, 18 and 59 women
- Compared with estradiol cream; no placebo
- No study on men's skin

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Effects in men
- Long-term safety
- Effect vs placebo
- Thyroid effects

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE
Not established for skin use

ROUTES STUDIED
On the skin (0.3% cream) in studies; vaginal cream in EU

PHARMACOKINETICS
Not established for skin use

SOLD AS
Compounded (Rx); not FDA approved

MONITORED IN TRIALS
Blood hormone levels, prolactin, breast checks

SPORT (WADA)
Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	No FDA-approved estriol drug; compounded only
FDA	503B Category 1 (under evaluation)
HPRA	Vaginal cream licensed (Ireland)
WADA	Not on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. Schmidt et al., Int J Dermatol, estradiol vs estriol creams for skin aging, Sep 1996
2. FDA, Menopause (women's health topics), Dec 2023
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

Adonis Men's Health · checked Nov 2026. Research and regulator records only. Not medical advice.

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